

Quang-Vinh Dang
British University Vietnam
Hung Yen, Vietnam
vinh.dq4@buv.edu.vn

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The Editor

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Dear Editor,

I am pleased to submit for your consideration the manuscript entitled “**What Financial Statements Can and Cannot Reveal About Monetary Transmission to Corporate Balance Sheets: A Five-Country Emerging-Market Test**” for publication in *Journal of International Financial Management & Accounting*.

Motivation. A productive literature shows that firms holding floating-rate debt bear the brunt of monetary tightening. It rests almost entirely on supervisory credit registries that record contract-level repricing terms. Most emerging markets have no such registry available to researchers; what they have is published financial statements. This paper asks, formally and empirically, whether the accounting record can substitute—and it matters, because the answer determines how far this literature can travel across the many emerging markets that will never have registry access.

The paper takes as its point of departure a recent contribution to *Borsa Istanbul Review* by Şengül and Çinko (2026, 26(4), 100837), which uses Turkish administrative data and a Double Machine Learning design to identify heterogeneous effects of the June 2023 tightening. My aim is complementary rather than critical: I ask what becomes possible, and what does not, when the administrative layer they exploit is unavailable, using their setting as one of five countries and their substantive question as the target.

What the paper does. I develop a measurement framework in which exposure is estimated rather than observed, deriving seven propositions, and take their predictions to harmonised panels of listed non-financial firms in five emerging markets—Türkiye, Vietnam, Poland, Israel and South Korea—over 2010–2025. Vietnam and Türkiye anchor the study with a decade of history and a natural contrast in dose—Türkiye tightened from 9% to a true peak of 50% while Vietnam tightened mildly and reversed within a year—and three further countries extend the test across a range of tightening severity in between.

The contributions are of three kinds:

1. **A validated price measure, confirmed across five countries.** A simple implied borrowing cost recovers each central bank’s policy path without being calibrated to it, peaking in Türkiye in 2024 at 31.2% as policy peaks at 50%. Pooling all five countries, the change in this measure correlates with policy tightening dose at $r = 0.995$ —a figure I read qualitatively rather than as a precise estimate, given how few countries that is—and median interest coverage falls in every single country. I use the two-country history to estimate pass-through of roughly one-third alongside a halving of median interest coverage.
2. **A data hazard bearing on exchange-rate measurement in emerging markets.** A

widely used Turkish vendor field bundles foreign-exchange revaluation into interest expense, so measures built on it peak in the lira crises of 2018 and 2021 rather than at the policy peak—a researcher would recover currency shocks and report them as monetary transmission. Separately, and more consequentially, Türkiye’s inflation-accounting restatement from 2022 indexes non-monetary assets while leaving monetary debt nominal; because the factor depends on asset vintage, the distortion enters a difference-in-differences as an exposure-by-post interaction that fixed effects cannot absorb. I show this generates highly significant, wrongly signed estimates.

3. **A transferable diagnostic.** I show that the split-half correlation of independently estimated exposures *is* the attenuation factor, not merely a diagnostic correlated with it, and that decomposing the variance separates imprecision from impermanence. In my data, conventional standard errors implied reliabilities of 0.664–0.923 where the split-half estimate of the permanent component was under 6%. A power calculation would have endorsed the design, or come close to it.

On the central result. The paper reports that no firm-level exposure gradient survives once contaminated outcomes are removed and the pre-period is long enough to test parallel trends, and that this null holds pooling all five countries: the exposure-by-dose interaction is insignificant on interest coverage and profitability regardless of how severely a country tightened, significant only on the price measure already shown to move with dose mechanically. I recognise that null findings warrant scrutiny, and the manuscript addresses this directly rather than by assertion: three significant results appeared during the analysis and each is shown to be an artefact—small-sample noise, accounting restatement, and pre-existing trend—by diagnostics a conventional specification would not have run, and I disclose in a footnote a fourth country (Brazil) assembled but not carried into the reported set, whose pass-through was anomalously low despite an adequate sample, so the reader can judge whether its exclusion affects the pattern. The framework explains the null structurally rather than attributing it to power.

Fit with the journal. The manuscript’s question is, at bottom, an international financial-reporting question rather than a purely macro-finance one: whether the published financial statements firms file under their own national accounting regimes can be pressed into service as a substitute for administrative credit-registry data, and where that substitution holds and breaks down. The paper’s two central diagnostics—a data field that conflates currency revaluation with interest cost, and an inflation-accounting restatement that a standard difference-in-differences specification cannot absorb—are accounting-measurement problems with direct consequences for empirical corporate-finance research using international financial statements, which I take to be squarely within this journal’s scope.

Author biography. Quang-Vinh Dang, PhD, is a Senior Lecturer at British University Vietnam and a Senior Data & AI Consultant at SmartOSC. His work spans artificial intelligence, machine learning, optimization, natural language processing, graph learning, and financial engineering. He has extensive experience bridging academic research and industrial AI, having held leadership roles in data science and AI across fintech, digital platforms, and enterprise technology. His industry work includes machine learning, recommendation systems, dynamic pricing, fraud detection, risk analytics, generative AI, agentic AI, and large-scale decision-support systems. He has authored more than 70 Scopus/SCI-E-indexed publications, including numerous articles in Q1 journals, and actively supervises research in advanced AI and optimization. Previously, he led multidisciplinary Data and AI teams and developed production-scale solutions for banking, retail, and digital-platform applications.

Declarations. This manuscript is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere. There are no conflicts of interest to declare and the research received no specific funding. I am the sole author. In accordance with the journal's double-blind review policy, identifying information is confined to the separate title page and the manuscript file contains none.

Thank you for considering this submission.

Yours sincerely,

Quang-Vinh Dang